



ENERGY WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 4 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 10 SEPTEMBER 2026

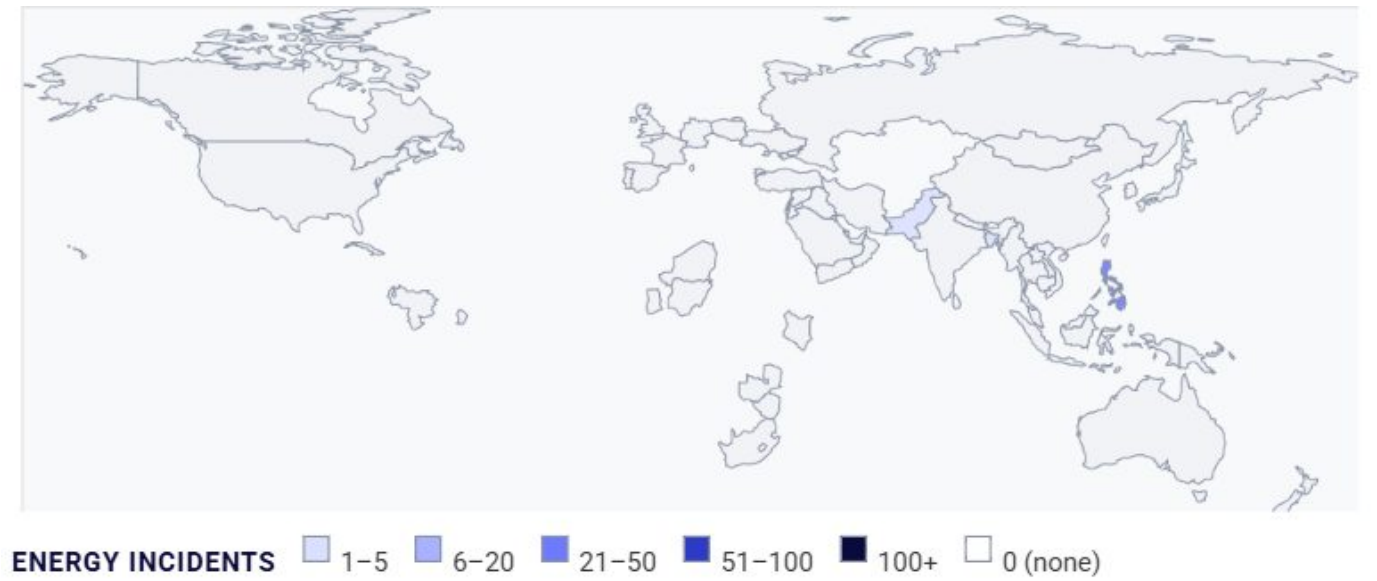
FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 4 Sep - 10 Sep 2026	TOTAL RECORDS 32 Energy this period	HIGHEST SEVERITY High Highest rating this period
TOP ISSUE TYPE Multiple energy incident types Data quality issue	MOST AFFECTED COUNTRY Philippines 25 records	LATEST INCIDENT 10 Sep 2026

BLUF

This window shows two clear pressure points: persistent grid stress in the Philippines' Visayas and repeated power-supply strain in Dhaka. The most acute operational issue was the High severity substation fire in Dhaka that cut power to parts of the city for hours, while in the Philippines the concern is sustained outage risk rather than a single standout failure. Conditions remain Low to Moderate in Pakistan on the available reporting, centred on electricity tariff pressure rather than reported grid disruption.

ENERGY SITUATION



MARKET PRICES

ELECTRICITY (US CITY AVG)

US city average retail electricity

0.197 USD/kWh

-0.5% MoM



As of Jul 2026 · BLS / FRED (APU000072610)

NATURAL GAS (EUROPE)

EU import natural gas

17.93 USD/MMBtu

+18.8% MoM



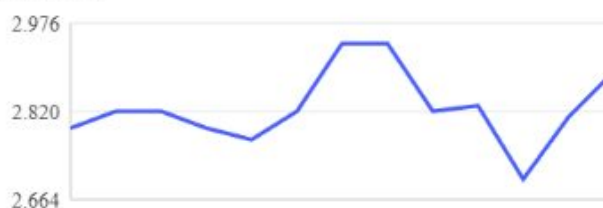
As of Jul 2026 · IMF / FRED (PNGASEUUSDM)

NATURAL GAS (HENRY HUB)

Henry Hub natural gas spot

2.900 USD/MMBtu

+7.4% 7d



As of Sep 2026 · EIA / FRED (DHHNGSP)

THERMAL COAL (AUSTRALIA)

Australian thermal coal

140.4 USD/mt

-6.6% MoM



As of Jul 2026 · IMF / FRED (PCOALAUUSDM)

ENERGY SITUATION

Power reliability remains uneven across the reporting area, with this window shaped less by fuel-to-power shocks and more by urban load shedding, localised infrastructure failure and regional generation shortfall.

Bangladesh reporting focused on Dhaka, where load shedding was openly discussed as something that would need to be accepted and where demand pressure was visible in reports that the city saw the highest load shedding on Saturday. In the Philippines, the Visayas grid remained under strain, including renewed red alert status and continued outage reporting. Pakistan reporting in this window pointed to rising electricity bills and a power tariff hike, which adds cost pressure but does not by itself indicate a new outage event during the period.

BANGLADESH / DHAKA

Dhaka saw the sharpest single disruption of the week when a substation fire cut power to parts of the city for hours. That High severity outage sat alongside wider reports of load shedding in the capital, including reporting that Dhaka recorded the highest load shedding on Saturday and that some load shedding would need to be accepted.

PHILIPPINES / VISAYAS

In the Philippines, pressure centred on the Visayas grid. Reporting described a worsening power crisis, continuing outages and a return to red alert on Tuesday afternoon. The disruption was serious enough to prompt moves to fast-track three energy projects and separate congressional inquiries sought by lawmakers from Negros Occidental.

Elsewhere, Bangladesh reporting also included commentary that June-July load shedding was lower than in the same period in 2023, but that did not alter the immediate picture of current strain in Dhaka. In Pakistan, reporting focused on a power tariff hike and rising electricity bills rather than a reported interruption to supply.

WHAT MATTERS

The main operational consequence is unreliable electricity in major urban and regional markets. In Dhaka, abrupt loss of power and recurring load shedding can disrupt building systems, lifts, cooling, connectivity and routine site access for several hours at a time. Staff travel can also be affected indirectly where traffic management and local services depend on stable electricity.

In the Philippines, the issue is continuity across the Visayas rather than one isolated asset failure. Continued outages and red alert conditions raise the chance of repeated interruptions to offices, accommodation, ports, retail activity and routine movements between islands and city centres. The Pakistan development matters chiefly as a cost issue in this window, with possible knock-on pressure on budgeting and vendor charges rather than direct access disruption on the reported record.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Confirm backup power status, fuel levels and transfer-switch readiness at Dhaka sites.
- Update local staff on possible short-notice loss of power in Dhaka and changes to building access arrangements.
- Review continuity plans for locations linked to the Visayas grid, including outages affecting connectivity and refrigeration.
- Check whether critical meetings or site tasks in the Visayas depend on stable mains power and reschedule where necessary.
- Reconfirm utility cost assumptions in Pakistan in light of the reported tariff hike.
- Prepare manual workarounds for reception, lifts, payment systems and communications during short-duration outages.

WATCH NEXT

- Further red alerts on the Visayas grid
- Any extension of outages beyond the current Visayas area
- Additional incidents affecting substations or distribution assets in Dhaka
- Official guidance on planned load shedding in Dhaka
- Progress on the three fast-tracked energy projects in the Philippines
- Any follow-on measures linked to congressional inquiries from Negros Occidental
- Further announcements on power tariff changes in Pakistan

POLESTAR VIEW

Risk level: Moderate. The most likely disruption in the near term is further interruption to power-dependent activity in Dhaka and across the Visayas, with the highest immediate concern where premises rely on uninterrupted electricity for access control, cooling and communications. Prioritise backup-power checks, short-notice outage communications and task scheduling around known peak-stress periods on these grids.

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